

Vernex Client Portal

Abstract, phased plan and UI direction

1. Abstract

The Vernex Client Portal ("Vernex Hub") is a multi-tenant web platform that gives each Vernex client one place to see project status, approve or request revisions on deliverables, share files, pay invoices and reach their account lead. It replaces the scattered WhatsApp and email threads that currently carry approvals, feedback and payments.

The portal is built on three ideas:

- **Answer-first dashboard.** In 15 seconds a client knows what Vernex is working on, what Vernex needs from them, and how many revisions remain.
- **Structured approvals and revisions.** Every approval, revision and comment is timestamped and attributed. This gives a counted, auditable revision system and an anti-scope-creep paper trail, with out-of-scope work turning into quoted change requests.
- **One codebase, two experiences.** Clients get a calm, mobile-first view. Vernex staff get a dense, fast view. Strict tenant isolation (PostgreSQL row-level security) and role-based permissions keep client data separate.

Supporting modules are a video and design reviewer, a content calendar, an asset vault, billing with GST invoicing and Razorpay, ad-performance dashboards, CSAT feedback, a Direct-to-Founder box, and an upsell and referral engine.

2. What to build, in what order

The PRD assumes 6 weeks, which is unrealistic for a team starting from zero. The order below follows one rule: build the approval loop first, because that is the product's core value. Everything else attaches to it. Durations assume a small team (about 2 developers plus a designer) and are easy to rescale.

Phase	Weeks	What gets built	Done when
0. Discovery and design foundation	1-2	Confirm scope with the stakeholder, collect real Vernex brand assets, interview 2-3 real clients and PMs, pick the MVP cut, design the identity and core screens in Figma with real content	Signed-off scope, brand direction and clickable designs for Dashboard, Approvals and Deliverable detail
1. Foundation	3-4	Repo, CI/CD, environments, DB schema (clients, users, projects, milestones, files, action_items, audit_logs), row-level security, auth (magic link and Google), invites, role-permission map, app shell	A client can log in and see only their own data, and a cross-tenant test proves it
2. Core loop (MVP heart)	5-8	Admin console to set up clients and projects, Dashboard (health badge, pipeline, Action Required banner, account lead card), deliverables and status machine, approve and request-revision flow, revision counter, approval inbox, email and WhatsApp notifications	Full loop works: upload deliverable, client reviews, requests revision, new version, approval

Phase	Weeks	What gets built	Done when
3. Files and review tools	9–11	Asset vault (folders, resumable uploads, signed URLs, previews, download tracking), image/PDF reviewer with pin comments, video reviewer (Mux, timecoded comments, versions), content calendar	Client can review and comment on a video or design and see versions
4. Money	12–13	Invoices with GST, Razorpay checkout and webhooks, receipts, delivery-vault gate on payment, change request and quote engine with e-accept	Client can pay online; an extra revision turns into a quote and then an invoice
5. Engagement and growth	14–15	CSAT micro-polls, Founder box and inbox, strategy call scheduler, ad KPI dashboards (Meta, Google), upsell cards, referral widget	Feedback reaches the founder; KPIs show on the dashboard
6. Hardening and launch	16	Load test, accessibility audit, DPDP checklist, bug bash, pilot launch with 2 clients	Pilot clients live, no tenancy leaks

Suggested cuts if time is tight

- Do the sprint board, staging iframe and source-code vault only if tech projects are a priority.
- Ship the video drawing tool as v1.1.
- Defer referrals, upsell rules and ROI cards.
- Use a manual CSV import as the fallback for ads data, since Meta and Google API approvals can take weeks. Start those applications in Phase 0.

3. Making the UI not look AI-made

The PRD's own design system is the main risk. Violet-to-teal gradients, glowing buttons, glassy dark surfaces, Space Grotesk plus Inter, and 16px-radius cards everywhere are the default look of AI-generated apps, and they also contradict the PRD's principle of calm simplicity for clients. The fixes below keep the functionality and change the identity.

Start from Vernex itself

Pull the actual logo, colours and tone from vernex.in and the team's existing work, and build the palette and type around them rather than a generic "tech" look.

Colour: one signal colour, used with discipline

- Warm paper-like background (off-white with a slight warm tint) and near-black ink for text, instead of cool grey-white.
- A single strong accent, such as vermilion or deep saffron, used only for "Action Required". This matches the PRD rule "blocking items are loud, everything else is quiet".
- No gradients. Flat colour and hairline borders.

Typography: choose something with character

- Pair a distinctive display face for headings and big numbers (a slightly editorial serif or an unusual grotesk) with a clean, less overused sans for the interface.
- Use a good monospace for timecodes, ticket keys and invoice numbers.
- Make sure Devanagari and Tamil render well, since client names and content will include them.
- Avoid Inter, Space Grotesk and Roboto.

Shape and surface

- Smaller radii (4–8px), mixed deliberately rather than one radius everywhere.
- Borders and spacing instead of drop shadows and glow.
- Denser tables and lists for staff screens, generous whitespace only on the client dashboard.

Components: never ship library defaults

- If you use shadcn/ui, treat it as a starting point and restyle every component with your own tokens. Unstyled shadcn is the most recognisable tell.
- Use a custom or adjusted icon set instead of stock Lucide at default weight, and never use emoji as icons.
- Design your own status pills, progress steppers and revision meter, since these are your signature elements.

Content and detail

- Design in Figma with real client names, real deliverables and real INR amounts, never lorem ipsum.
- Write microcopy in Vernex's own voice, with some Hinglish-friendly warmth where it fits. Avoid "Welcome back" and "Unlock the power of...".
- Make empty states specific and useful, using real photography or simple illustration drawn for Vernex, not generic blob art.
- Avoid the standard hero, three feature cards and CTA layout. Let the dashboard's content decide its layout.

Mobile

Design the approval screens at 360px first. Most clients will open them from a WhatsApp link on a phone.

4. Things to flag to your stakeholder early

- The 6-week timeline in the PRD is not realistic for building from scratch.
- Decide up front whether tech projects (sprint board, staging, code vault) are in the first release or later.
- Ad API approvals and WhatsApp Business API setup have lead times, so apply in Phase 0.
- Tenant isolation is the highest-risk area, so run automated cross-tenant tests in CI from Phase 1.